Australia strained interpretations of Ottawa have led to an increase of tariffs on certain classes of piece goods and yarns, and this has been bitterly resented by the Lancashire cotton industry and denounced by them as a breach of the Ottawa Agreement. As a protest and a reprisal, a movement for the boycott of Australian goods was inaugurated in Lancashire. This threat had little effect on Australia, where an aggressive attitude was taken up.[1]

The economic conflicts are obviously not due to any ill-will that the people of Canada and Australia may have for Britain, though in Ireland's case that ill-will is apparent. Conflicts occur because interests clash, and wherever such clashes might take place, the object of 'safeguards' in India is to see that British interests prevail. The recent Indo-British Trade Agreement, arrived at secretly over the heads and despite the protests of Indian business and industry, although British industrialists were kept informed, rejected by the Legislative Assembly and yet persisted in by the Government, is a gentle indication of what 'safeguards' would lead to. Such 'safeguards' seem to be urgently needed in Canada, Australia and South Africa to prevent the people of those Dominions from going astray not only in trade matters but in matters of greater concern to the safety and cohesion of the Empire.[2]

Empire, it has been said, is Debt, and the 'safeguards' have been devised to enable the imperial moneylender to keep his stranglehold on his unfortunate debtor, and to keep all his special interests and powers intact. A curious doctrine, often

[1] The Melbourne *Age* declared that if the proposed Lancashire boycott is not dropped, Australia must hit harder at whatever trade with Lancashire still remains. Lancashire is to be answered "with unwavering reiteration." (Quoted in *Manchester Guardian Weekly*, November 9, 1934.)

[2] Mr. O. Pirow, Minister for Defence of the Union of South Africa, stated that the Union would not take part in any general scheme of Imperial Defence, nor would it participate in an overseas war even though Britain might be at war. "If the Government attempted rashly to commit South Africa to participate in another overseas war there would be large-scale disturbances, possibly civil war. Hence Government would not participate in any general scheme of Imperial Defence." (Reuter message dated Cape Town, February 5, 1935.) General Hertzog, the Prime Minister, has confirmed this declaration and stated that it represents the Union Government's policy.